

Tapping Global Education



PAWAN BHAWAR

INDORE The country's educational system achieved a major milestone when King Constantine II of Greece attended the opening ceremony of the first-ever International Round Square Conference at Daly College on October 19. The group of 60 schools across the world, stands for a greater purpose in education beyond preparing students for college and university. It promotes vigorous student exchanges and has patrons such as Nelson Mandela and the Duke of York, with Sonia Gandhi also being a patron for some years.

The Indian chapter will allow Indian students to plug into an established

global network and get international exposure. At the conference, students from Tiger Kloof, South Africa, and The Southport School, Australia, were keen to explore what lay beyond cricket in a country they were getting to hear so much about lately.

Round Square President King Constantine, full of witticism in his 40th attendance, and first-time visitor Nita Ambani, with her keen insight into school education and her own experiences at the Dhirubhai Ambani International School, represented the breadth of involvement of diverse strands in school education. The organisation's



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MILESTONE: Students at the conference (left); King Constantine II

Indian members number 10 and include the likes of Doon School, Scindia School, Mayo College, Ajmer and Lawrence School, Sanawar.

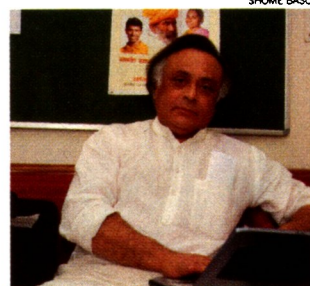
Sumer Singh, principal of Daly College says, "We are consciously promoting the idea of lateral leadership, allowing students to take charge of affairs which would otherwise be a domain of management or faculty." This, he says, would prepare them for the complexities of a fast-globalising world. India's global citizen is set to get a lot younger.

by Ambresh Mishra

Banana Republic

DELHI The rising rupee has nothing to do with it, but despite being the world's largest producer of bananas, India's share of the world banana trade is abysmal. At a national seminar on banana in Tiruchrapalli recently, Jairam Ramesh, Union minister of state for commerce, said India accounts for about 23 per cent of

SHOME BASU



FRUITFUL: Ramesh

the global output, about three times the share of the next country, Brazil. Over five lakh small and medium farmers are involved in banana cultivation. About one-third of India's fruit production is accounted for by banana alone. Banana production in India has doubled in the past 20 years—the challenge will be to double it in the next 10 years.

However, India does not figure anywhere in international banana trade that is worth over \$4 billion (Rs 1,600 crore) and controlled by Ecuador, Costa Rica, Philippines and Colombia. Five big global multinationals control banana trade particularly as far as the US and European markets are concerned. The minister was confident that India will be able to garner 5 per cent share in international trade in 10 years with focus on China, Japan, Russia and particularly the Middle East.

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